as the land of abundance. As is well known, Columbus failed in his original mission and never reached India. This story is invoked not only to remind modern investors and explorers of the fabled attractions of India, but also to assure them of safe navigation to India. In a reversal of role, this time it is India inviting the world to its shores, to partake in its capitalist growth story. Witness, too, how India's past encounters with the world were deployed in an unusual way to bolster its brand in the 21st century.

It is, perhaps, therefore, the hypothetical availability of the domain name that India has drawn forth old, forgotten historical bitterness over how the two successor states of British India ought to have been named. Many recalled how Jinnah was reported to have been left disappointed when Nehru chose to retain the name India. He is said to have expected independent India to be called Hindustan or Bharat to signal a break from colonialism. Instead, the makers of modern India had taken possession of an established name, variations of which had existed since antiquity, and fused it together with Bharat to inscribe a double name 'India, that is Bharat' in the Constitution. The new nomenclature not only harnessed a widely recognised name but also became a mark of historical continuity that wove together the many old Indias to the new postcolonial state. If Bharat addressed an internal constituency, especially the consumers of Hindu identity, the familiar sign of India became the cosmopolitan interface between the nation and the world.

Seen through the logic of the brand, what allows Bharat to become visible in the world is Brand India. The cancellation of India is a narrow, partisan move, one that accrues losses to both Bharat and India. ■

***– Ravinder Kaur** is the author of* **Brand New Nation: Capitalist Dreams and Nationalist Designs in Twenty-First-Century India**



By **BARADWAJ RANGAN**

WHAT'S IN A NAME?

HAD INDIA'S BIGGEST UNITERS–FILMS AND FILM MUSIC–FANCIED ONE NAME OVER THE OTHER, WHAT WOULD BECOME OF *MOTHER INDIA*, OR *RAJA HINDUSTANI*, OR *BHARAT EK KHOJ*?

